

Teva and the Sword Maker:

In a faraway village, there lived a young boy named Teva. On his tenth birthday, Teva was sent to the sword maker to become an apprentice. Teva thought it would be exciting to learn how to make swords, so he went happily to learn from the famous craftsman. He was surprised when he discovered that his teacher was a very old man who could no longer see nor hear very well. "How will I learn anything from him?" Teva asked his father. "He's so old and can barely walk." "Respect your teacher!" His father told him. "He is a master sword maker with much experience. You will learn many things." Teva took lessons from the old sword maker each day, and he soon realized that his father was right. The old man looked weak and feeble, but when he was making a sword, his skills were amazing.

Teva's respect for the sword maker grew every day. He learned to watch closely, ask for help when necessary, and always listen carefully as the sword maker explained what he was doing. One day an evil dragon flew into town, breathing fire and knocking down houses with its long, scaly tail. Teva ran to the sword maker and asked what he should do. The sword maker told Teva to take the smallest sword from the highest shelf and attack the dragon. At first, Teva thought the old man was crazy. The smallest sword would barely scratch the dragon's thick scales. But then he thought back on his lessons, and how much he respected the sword maker's teachings. Trusting the old man's words, he grabbed the smallest sword and took off after the dragon. The whole village battled the huge dragon for hours, and finally, Teva had a chance to plunge the small sword into the dragon's neck. The instant he did, the sword began to flow with a bright, white, light. The dragon fell dead, and Teva became the hero of the village. "How did you know to use that small sword?" asked the amazed soldiers. "I trusted the words of my wise teacher," Teva explained.